
A FEATURE SCREENPLAY — ELEVATED THRILLER / HORROR

MASK SLIP

“When you see it, you cannot unsee it.”

Story & Screenplay by Zoe Miller

Based on her original song “The Mask” — [zoemcreative \(YouTube\)](#)

The one-line pitch

When her estranged younger sister vanishes into an upstate wellness retreat, a sound healer who spent four years surviving a narcissist of her own goes undercover inside the compound — and has to decide whether the charismatic founder's hold over dozens of followers is a supernatural hunger passed down four generations, or simply the most ordinary evil this country produces, dressed in incense and good lighting, before her sister becomes its next “Primary Supply.”

Horror as a literal translation of abuse

DARVO

Deny, Attack, Reverse Victim and Offender — the founder's reflex under any accusation.

Love-bombing → isolation

The exact grooming arc, dramatized scene by scene, not explained.

Flying monkeys

Weaponized kindness — a community that surrounds a target with warmth until compliance looks like healing.

She doesn't destroy it. She alchemizes it.

At the climax, Wren refuses the genre's own weapon: no fight, no fire, no confirmed kill. She simply stops performing fear, shame, and an audience — the three things the entity, or the man, or both, have always fed on. Whatever leaves Rafe doesn't leave because he earned it. It leaves because there's nothing left to eat, and goes looking for a fuller room.

The film never confirms whether what she faced was literal or psychological.

That ambiguity is load-bearing. It is not a loose end.

What happens

Sound healer WREN MERCER gets a frightened voicemail from her sister IVY, newly devoted to the Aurelia Circle — a wellness retreat run by magnetic RAFFA AURELIO and his wife SELAH. Inside the gates: a community that is genuinely, maddeningly both real healing and real predation, running on the same machinery.

Wren finds a ledger tracking members as “Supply” back to 1911 — and her sister's initial already penciled in as next. Her confrontation with Rafe isn't a fight. It's a refusal, and the room doesn't survive it the way anyone in it expected.

Who's inside the gates

WREN MERCER

Sound healer. A Derek-survivor whose arc is learning that refusing to perform for an audience is its own power.

RAFE AURELIO

Grandiose founder. Possibly a vessel for something four generations old. The film never says which.

NAN CASSIDY

Wren's mentor — lost her own daughter to the organization's earlier form in 1994.

IVY MERCER

Wren's younger sister — quietly groomed as the next “Primary Supply.”

SELAH AURELIO

Covert co-founder — unnervingly self-aware, most likely to tell a true thing and a manipulative one in the same breath.

Masks, rank, and a ledger that never says “died”

The mask hierarchy

Wood → bone → silver → gold, rising with rank. Only Rafe wears gold.

The ledger

Members tracked as “Supply,” “Primary,” and “Transferred” — never “died,” never “left.”

The Hollow

The ambiguous presence at the center of the Unveiling — fully explained by hidden subwoofers and drugged tea, and never fully explained at all.

Where this sits on the shelf

PAN'S LABYRINTH *dark-fairytale ambiguity, ritual imagery that never confirms itself*

HEREDITARY *ambiguity as structure, not cop-out*

THE INVITATION *slow-burn dread of infiltrating a compound from inside*

MARTHA MARCY MAY MARLENE *grounded, unsentimental cult psychology*

MIDSOMMAR *communal, sunlit dread*

SOUND OF MY VOICE *restraint around the central unanswered question*

Built to seed a slate

The Aurelia Circle is explicitly one of at least nine “sister circles” operating nationally — established on the page, not invented after the fact.

The closing scene shows the pattern surviving this film's ending: a town official goes briefly “present but absent” while approving a new partnership under a different name and logo.

This supports an anthology model, not a direct sequel — each future installment following a new protagonist inside a different sister circle, independently pitchable and castable, while preserving one mythology across a slate.

Zoe Miller

Screenwriter and songwriter with scripts listed on The Black List. MASK SLIP is adapted from her original song of the same thematic DNA, which she owns outright — a real packaging asset for trailer, teaser, and marketing use, distinct from the screenplay itself.

“When you see it / you cannot un-see it / the mask slip / the horror of the reveal / of what lies beneath.”

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Feature | 94 pages | Elevated Thriller / Horror

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